

Whose Geopolitical Risk? Local Media and Producer Prices in Asia

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Preliminary — comments welcome

We construct monthly geopolitical risk (GPR) indices from domestic newspapers for 17 Asian economies—27 country-language series in six languages over 1995–2026—including the first general-purpose domestic indices for nine economies. Locally perceived risk diverges systematically from both global Anglosphere GPR and Anglosphere attention toward each economy, spiking around geographically concentrated conflicts. In panel local projections, a one-standard-deviation increase in local GPR raises producer prices by roughly 0.8 percent over two years, preceded by immediate currency depreciation and higher energy import bills at flat volumes, while manufacturing output never rises. The Anglosphere benchmark traces the same path without precision: the identifiable price signal resides in local-language coverage. Geopolitical risk transmits to producer prices where it is felt, not where it is reported. (*JEL* C43, D74, E31, F14, F51)

Keywords: geopolitical risk; text analysis; local media; producer prices; supply chains; local projections; Asia.

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